CARDS: CENTER · STRETCH · TOP · SPREAD

The author decides where a card row's spare height goes

A row of cards gets the whole stage. When the cards are sparse, that height goes somewhere — and only the author knows where.

Stretch fills the row, and a short card carries the difference.

What this used to do.

Every deck rendered card rows this way.

Right when cards are full.

A three-line card uses what it gets.

Wrong when they are sparse.

A one-line card is as tall as the row.

Still worth asking for.

A full grid, or one above a key-insight panel.

Center shrinks the cards and centers the band.

The default now.

Omit the key and you get this.

Cards fit their text.

Each line takes what its tallest card needs.

One gutter.

Rows stay `gap` apart, matching the columns.

The cost.

The band stops short of the stage floor.

Top anchors the band where the eye enters.

Under the rule.

Gutter kept · Band centered

Cards start below the headline. Nothing floats.

Spare height below.

Gutter kept · Band centered

Spare height collects at the bottom.

Composition void.

Gutter kept · Band centered

Where the content ends is the deck's business.

Spread shares the height out between the rows.

Rows move apart.

Void gone · Gutter kept

The row gap grows; the column gap does not.

Measured.

Void gone · Gutter kept

Measured at 4.2x the column gutter.

Use it deliberately.

Void gone · Gutter kept

Two sparse rows carry it; a dense grid cannot.

One token, and every default survives it.

01

A class sets a variable

`cards: top` stamps a class that sets `--cards-align`.

02

Each row keeps its own default

Each row reads the variable with its own fallback.

03

So a rule keeps its own default

`cards: center` stamps nothing; each fallback wins.

04

And the splitter still wins

Split pages override it, so a run stays uniform.

CENTER IS THE DEFAULT — EVERY OTHER COMPOSITION IS ONE LINE OF FRONT MATTER AWAY.

Four values, one default, nothing forced.